

gemstone-rs Explorer Guide

Local HTTP explorer endpoints and safety defaults



Generated from the Markdown sources in `gemstone-rs/docs`.

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Explorer Guide

`gemstone-rs-explorer` is a local-only HTTP explorer built on the Rust API. It is useful for proving the browser, inspect, eval, and codegen surfaces before embedding richer tooling in VS Code or another frontend.

Install and Run

```
cargo install gemstone-rs-explorer
gemstone-rs-explorer --port 8787
```

From a checkout:

```
cargo run -p gemstone-rs-explorer -- --port 8787
```

If you launch the explorer outside the project checkout, point codegen discovery and relative config paths at the checkout explicitly:

```
gemstone-rs-explorer --port 8787 --codegen-root /path/to/gemstone-rs
```

Open:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8787/
```

The home page is a small browser UI over the same JSON endpoints. It can:

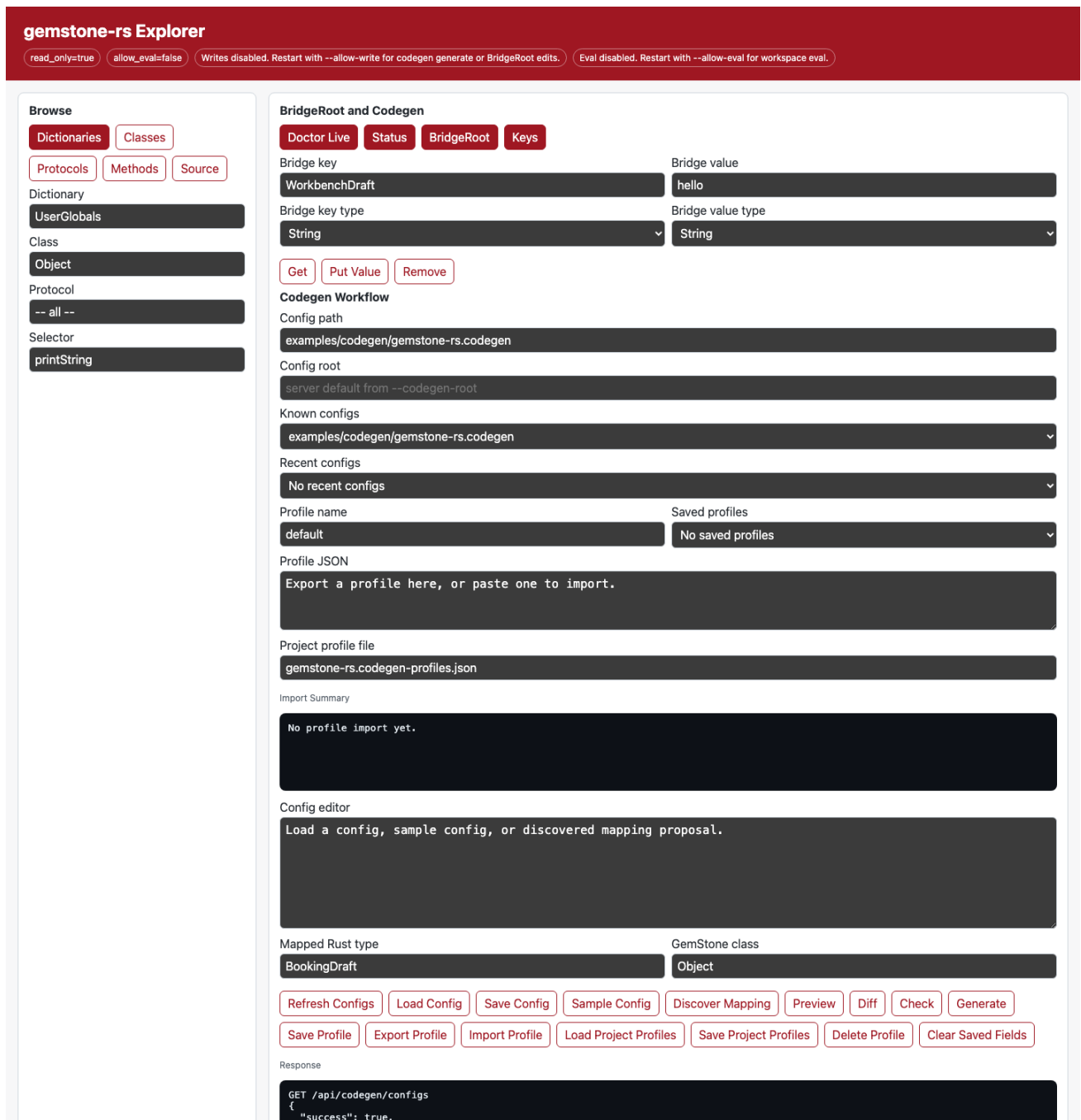
- browse dictionaries, classes, protocols, methods, and source
- run doctor/status checks
- inspect BridgeRoot and list keys
- run codegen sample/discover/preview/diff/check/generate from an editable

config path

- refresh a picker of known `.codegen` files and load one without typing the path by hand
- set a project codegen root through `--codegen-root`, or override it from the page before refreshing configs

- reuse recently loaded, saved, previewed, diffed, checked, or generated config paths from local browser storage
- save named codegen profiles containing config root, config path, mapped Rust type, and GemStone class
- export and import codegen profiles as versioned JSON for sharing between browsers or teammates
- load project profile files from the codegen root, and save them back when the explorer runs with `--allow-write`
- load and save the selected codegen config file; saving is still gated by `--allow-write`, accepts a POST body for larger configs, and validates the config before writing
- render generated wrapper source, generated mapping config, colored unified diff output, and a side-by-side diff in a dedicated detail pane
- remember the current browser fields locally across reloads
- put/remove BridgeRoot values with explicit string/symbol key policy and string/small-int/bool value policy when `--allow-write` is enabled

Screenshot:



Refresh it with:

```
make screenshots
```

See [Screenshot Workflow](#) for the repeatable capture process.

Safety Defaults

The explorer:

- binds to `127.0.0.1` by default
- rejects non-loopback hosts
- starts read-only
- requires `--allow-eval` before workspace evaluation
- requires `--allow-write` before codegen writes
- reads GemStone credentials from the same `GS_*` environment as the CLI

Do not expose it publicly without adding authentication and transport security.

Browse Endpoints

Run these from a second terminal:

```
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/health
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/config
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/doctor
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/doctor?live=1'
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/status
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/browse/dictionaries
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/browse/classes?dictionary=UserGlobals'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/browse/protocols?class=Object&meta=0'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/browse/methods?class=Object&protocol=-%20all%20--&meta=0'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/browse/source?class=Object&selector=printString&meta=0'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/inspect?oop=20'
```

Expected shapes:

```
{"status":"ok"}
{"host":"127.0.0.1","port":8787,"readOnly":true,"allowEval":false}
{"success":true,"environment":{"GS_PASSWORD":{"status":"set","masked":true}}}
{"connected":true,"sessionId":12345,"needsCommit":false,"inTransaction":false}
{"success":true,"dictionaries":["UserGlobals"]}
```

Eval

Eval is disabled by default:

```
gemstone-rs-explorer --allow-eval
```

Then:

```
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/eval?source=3%20%2B%204'
```

Expected:

```
{"type":"smallInt","value":7}
```

Codegen Endpoints

The home page includes a Codegen Workflow panel. Set `Config path`, optionally set `Config root`, or start the server with `--codegen-root`. `Refresh Configs` and the `Known configs` picker choose an existing `.codegen` file relative to that root. The `Recent configs` picker remembers paths used by Load, Save, Preview, Diff, Check, and Generate in local browser storage. `Saved profiles` store the root, config path, mapped Rust type, and GemStone class as a named local browser profile. `Export Profile` writes a versioned JSON payload to `Profile JSON`; paste that JSON into another explorer and use `Import Profile` to merge it into saved profiles. `Load Project Profiles` reads `gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json` from the codegen root by default, while `Save Project Profiles` writes the current saved profiles back to that file when the explorer runs with `--allow-write`. Optionally enter a mapped Rust type and GemStone class, then use:

- `Config root` to override the server default for config discovery and relative config paths
- `Refresh Configs` to scan the project root for known `.codegen` files
- `Recent configs` to return to the last few config paths used in this browser
- `Save Profile` and `Saved profiles` to switch between named codegen workflows
- `Export Profile` and `Import Profile` to share a codegen workflow as JSON
- `Load Project Profiles` and `Save Project Profiles` to use a committed

project-level profile file; the server rejects invalid profile schemas and the browser reports which profiles are new, replaced, or unchanged

- `Load Config` to read the selected config file into the editor
- `Save Config` to POST the editor contents, validate them, and write the file

when the explorer was started with `--allow-write`

- `Sample Config` to view the starter config format
- `Discover Mapping` to ask a live stone for a mapping config proposal

- **Preview** to inspect generated Rust wrappers without writing files
- **Diff** to compare generated output with the committed file; the detail pane

shows both the exact unified diff and a side-by-side view for review

- **Check** to fail when generated output is stale
- **Generate** to write wrappers when the explorer was started with

--allow-write

Read-only endpoints:

```
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/sample
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/configs?root=.'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/profiles?profile_file=gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/config?config=examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/preview?config=examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/diff?config=examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/check?config=examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/discover-mapping?mapped=BookingDraft&class=Object'
```

The repository includes a sample project profile file:

```
examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json
```

Expected read-only results include the config list and a current generated output check:

```
{"success":true,"root":".", "configs":["examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen"]}
{"success":true,"exists":true,"upToDate":true}
```

Write-gated endpoint:

```
gemstone-rs-explorer --allow-write
```

```
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/generate?config=examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen'
curl -s -X POST \
  --data-binary @gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json \
  'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/profiles/save?profile_file=gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json'
curl -s -X POST \
```



```
--data-binary @examples/codegen/gemstone-rs.codegen \
'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/codegen/config/save?config=examples/codegen/
draft.codegen'
```

Expected:

```
{"success":true,"output":"examples/codegen/generated/
gemstone_wrappers.rs","bytes":1234}
{"success":true,"config":"examples/codegen/draft.codegen","bytes":512}
```

Project profile files use this shape:

```
{"kind":"gemstone-rs-explorer-codegen-profiles","version":1,"profiles":
[{"name":"default","config":"examples/codegen/gemstone-
rs.codegen","root":"","mapped":"BookingDraft","className":"Object"}]}
```

Validate the file before sharing or saving it from CI:

```
gemstone-rs profile validate gemstone-rs.codegen-profiles.json
```

The schema reference is [Codegen Profile Schema](#).

For write endpoints, relative `config=` and `profile_file=` paths are resolved inside the codegen root. Paths containing `..` are rejected after URL decoding, `root=...` traversal is rejected as well, and absolute write paths require starting the explorer with `--allow-absolute-write-paths`.

Project profile saves validate the JSON before writing. The top-level object must contain only `kind`, `version`, and `profiles`; profile names are required and unique; and each profile may contain only string-valued `name`, `config`, `root`, `mapped`, and `className` fields.

BridgeRoot Endpoints

BridgeRoot inspection and mapping-config preview use the same live session configuration as the browser endpoints:

```
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/root
curl -s http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/keys
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/get?key=BookingDraft'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/get?key=BookingDraft&key_type=Symbol'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/mapping-config?mapped=BookingDraft'
```

The browser UI exposes `Bridge key type` and `Bridge value type` controls so you can explicitly test string-key, symbol-key, string-value, small-int-value, and bool-value mappings before encoding them in a reusable config file. It persists the selected key, value, class, selector, config, and mapping fields in browser local storage; use `Clear Saved Fields` to reset the page back to the documented defaults.

Writes are disabled unless the explorer is started with `--allow-write`:

```
gemstone-rs-explorer --allow-write
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/put?key=WorkbenchDraft&value=hello'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/put?
key=WorkbenchCount&value=7&value_type=SmallInt'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/put?
key=WorkbenchApproved&value=true&value_type=Bool'
curl -s 'http://127.0.0.1:8787/api/bridge/remove?key=WorkbenchDraft'
```

Expected shapes:

```
{"success":true,"name":"GemStoneRsBridgeRoot","oop":1234,"identityId":1}
{"success":true,"root":"GemStoneRsBridgeRoot","keys":
[{"printString":"BookingDraft"}]}
{"oop":5678,"classOop":9012,"printString":"aDictionary(...)" }
{"success":true,"config":"mapped = BookingDraft ..."}
{"success":true,"root":"GemStoneRsBridgeRoot","key":"WorkbenchDraft","keyType":"String",
"valueType":"String","oop":3456}
```

Product Direction

The explorer should remain a separate binary crate. The core `gemstone-rs` library stays focused on safe GemStone API access, while the explorer proves higher-level browsing and codegen workflows.

Good next steps:

- short GIFs showing profile import, codegen preview, and BridgeRoot checks
- deeper VS Code webview integration

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